

Carmick Shift

John Carmack's shift to Oculus VR is a move that has the potential to forever change the way we game. Here's why: <http://dgit.in/Carmick>

Life at 2400bps

What was life like at 2400bps? You young 'uns need to read this. <http://dgit.in/1dWSWNJ>

and we couldn't pin-point the source of the problem. We were using the Enterprise edition of Windows 8 and not the default version that comes bundled on the laptop itself so we're not laying the blame on the Vaio. Also, this shouldn't be an issue in everyday use as we didn't face any problems while using the device.

The AMD A8 APU should give you reasonable gaming performance and while the Lenovo 505s does feature the A10 APU and a similar feature set, it's also considerably more expensive. Sony's had something of a reputation for overpricing their laptops, but this one's a great deal at this price.

If you're looking for a multimedia laptop, look no further than the Vaio Fit 15E.

Acer Aspire V5-472

This is a surprisingly likeable laptop and also a surprisingly disappointing one. The Aspire V5-472 features a very slim chassis that looks very elegant and is well-built. The screen is quite good but definitely not much better than average. The bezel is quite slim and the battery is built-in, so can't be reached easily if you do need to change it.

The laptop does feature a somewhat unusual (some would say uncomfortable) port layout wherein you only have one USB 2.0 port on either side of the device, but you do get a USB 3.0 and Thunderbolt port on the rear of its spine.

Yes, you read that right, a Thunderbolt port on a budget laptop. There aren't many devices that take advantage of Thunderbolt yet, definitely when it doesn't offer much more over USB 3.0, but the option is present. The rear of the device also hosts the HDMI



Dell Inspiron 14R 5420

port and the LAN port, which has a spring-loaded flap that partly obscures it (for aesthetic considerations we assume).

All this is well and good, the laptop is slim, cheap, comes with Thunderbolt and is adequately equipped, but there's one thing that completely ruins the laptop for us and that's the touchpad. For whatever reason, the touchpad on this particular V5 was so hyper-sensitive that it bordered on the pre-cognitive, dancing and jumping all over the screen the moment more than one finger came anywhere

near it. We tried uninstalling and reinstalling drivers to no avail. We're not sure if this issue was specific to the review sample we received, but the touch response was enough to completely turn us against the device. Purchasing this laptop would have been a no-brainer with a better touchpad.

This is a great laptop, one of the slimmest you can buy at the price and easily the most feature-rich here, not to mention the 4+ hour battery life. However, the awful touchpad completely ruins the experience and we cannot, in good

conscience, recommend the device to anyone.

Dell Inspiron 14R 5420

Powered by an Intel Core i5 CPU, this is one of the more powerful laptops in our comparison. The device features excellent connectivity in the form of four USB 3.0 ports and also hosts one of the better screens in the comparison. In fact, both the Dell laptops (including the Inspiron 11) aced our screen sharpness tests.

The laptop itself is a bit large and bulky, but the keyboard is roomy and comfortable and the touchpad is quite good, though its keys are a bit stiff. Volume levels and audio quality were a bit on the lower side, but at least not as bad as the levels on the S210 Touch.

Battery life was also barely acceptable at 2.5hrs in our tests, which means that it should last you upwards of three hours. We were also very disappointed with the thermal efficiency of the design. Load temperatures were in the 70s and we expected much better temperature management from such a large device, though the CPU must share some of the blame here— it's a powerful one after all.

The 14R should have been slimmer and run cooler, other laptops have managed it in the same price and with the same screen size. It's not a bad product, but it's hard to recommend over the competition.

Best Performer Lenovo G500s Touch

The best performer in this test has to be something special, and it truly is. The G500s touch ticks all the right boxes as far as



Lenovo G500s Touch